

REACH

1. Passage anchor

> “Instead of simply pointing out mistakes, she gave constructive feedback and made you feel that **improvement was within reach**.”

Passage meaning

within reach = possible to achieve; attainable

觸手可及；**可以實現**；**有望達成**

Here, **reach** is metaphorical. The basic physical idea is “the distance your hand can extend to,” and that develops into “something close enough to obtain or achieve.”

Practice

1. Her encouragement made improvement feel **within reach**.

她的鼓勵讓人覺得進步是**可以做到的**。

2. With enough practice, that goal is **within reach**.

只要有足夠的練習，那個目標是**有望達成的**。

Core meanings of REACH

2. reach something — arrive at a place

reach + place = arrive at / get to a place

到達；**抵達**

This normally takes a direct object, so we say **reach the station**, not ***reach to the station***.

Examples

1. We finally **reached the hotel** after midnight.

我們終於在午夜過後**抵達飯店**。

2. The climbers **reached the summit** just before sunset.

登山者在日落前不久**到達山頂**。

Key distinction

* **reach London** 

* **arrive in London** 

* **get to London** 

* *reach to London* 

3. reach a particular point, level, stage, age, number, etc.

= attain or come to a particular state, level, amount, stage, age, or point

達到；到達（某程度、階段、數字、年齡等）

This extends the physical “arrive at” idea into abstract scales or stages.

Examples

1. Temperatures may **reach 35°C** this afternoon.

今天下午氣溫可能**達到攝氏35度**。

2. The company has **reached a critical stage** in its development.

這家公司已**進入發展中的關鍵階段**。

Common objects:

* reach adulthood 達到成年

* reach maturity 成熟

* reach a peak 達到高峰

* reach a certain level 達到某程度

* reach 100 到達100

* reach retirement age 達到退休年齡

4. reach a goal, target, objective, standard, etc.

= succeed in attaining something aimed for

達成；達到（目標、標準等）

This is an achievement-focused extension of Sense 3.

Examples

1. She worked hard to **reach her goal** of becoming a doctor.

她努力工作，以**達成成為醫生的目標**。

2. Several students have already **reached the required standard**.

幾名學生已經**達到所要求的標準**。

Compare

* **reach a goal** = arrive at the desired result

* **achieve a goal** = successfully accomplish it

They often overlap strongly.

5. reach a decision, agreement, conclusion, verdict, compromise, etc.

= arrive at something after discussion, thought, negotiation, or consideration

達成；作出；得出

The object is usually a mental or collective outcome.

Examples

1. After two hours of discussion, we finally **reached an agreement**.

經過兩小時討論後，我們終於**達成協議**。

2. The investigators have not yet **reached a conclusion**.

調查人員尚未**得出結論**。

Common combinations:

* reach a decision 作出決定

* reach an agreement 達成協議

* reach a conclusion 得出結論

* reach a compromise 達成妥協

* reach a verdict 作出裁決

6. reach for something

= stretch out your hand or arm in order to take or touch something

伸手去拿；伸手去碰

Examples

1. He **reached for his phone** when it started ringing.

電話一響，他便**伸手去拿手機**。

2. The child **reached for the toy** on the shelf.

那個孩子**伸手去拿架上的玩具**。

Important

This is different from **reach something**.

* **reach the shelf** = your hand can get as far as the shelf

* **reach for the book** = make the movement of stretching your hand toward the book

7. reach out / reach your hand or arm

= stretch or extend a body part toward something

伸出 ; 伸展

Examples

1. She **reached out a hand** to help him up.

她**伸出一隻手**扶他起來。

2. He **reached across the table** for the salt.

他**伸手越過桌面**去拿鹽。

This sense focuses on the physical extension of the body.

8. be able to touch or take something because it is close enough

= be physically able to get to something with your hand, arm, etc.

搆得到 ; 伸手可及

Examples

1. I'm too short to **reach the top shelf**.

我太矮了 , **搆不到最上層的架子**。

2. Can you **reach the light switch** from there?

你從那裡**搆得到電燈開關嗎** ?

9. something reaches somewhere

= extend as far as a particular place or point

延伸至 ; 一直到

Here, the subject itself extends over a distance.

Examples

1. Her hair ****reached her shoulders****.

她的頭髮****垂到肩膀****。

2. The forest ****reaches all the way to the coast****.

森林****一直延伸到海岸****。

Other examples:

* water reached my knees 水淹到我的膝蓋

* the road reaches the border 道路延伸到邊境

10. reach a person by phone, email, etc.

= successfully contact or communicate with someone

****聯絡到；取得聯繫****

Examples

1. I tried calling her, but I couldn't ****reach her****.

我試著打電話給她，但一直****聯絡不上她****。

2. You can ****reach me by email**** if you have any questions.

如果有任何問題，你可以用電子郵件****聯絡我****。

Useful distinction

****contact**** is slightly more neutral/formal.

****reach**** often emphasizes successfully getting through to the person.

11. reach an audience / people / customers

= communicate with, affect, attract, or become accessible to a group of people

****接觸到；觸及；影響到****

Examples

1. Social media allows small businesses to ****reach more customers****.

社群媒體讓小型企業能**接觸更多顧客**。

2. The campaign is designed to **reach younger audiences**.

這項宣傳活動旨在**觸及較年輕的受眾**。

This is especially common in:

* media

* advertising

* education

* public communication

12. information, news, sound, etc. reaches someone

= become known to or perceived by someone

傳到；傳入；傳達到

Examples

1. News of the accident soon **reached his family**.

事故的消息很快便**傳到他的家人那裡**。

2. The sound of music **reached us** from across the street.

音樂聲從街對面**傳到我們耳中**。

The subject moves figuratively or physically until it comes to the receiver.

13. reach into / through / across an area

= extend, penetrate, or have an effect into a place, group, or domain

延伸至；深入；遍及

Examples

1. The company's network **reaches into rural areas**.

該公司的網絡**延伸至偏遠地區**。

2. The effects of the policy **reach far beyond education**.

這項政策的影響**遠遠超出教育領域**。

This often develops into figurative “scope of influence.”

Noun meanings

14. reach — the distance you can stretch your arm

= the distance within which you can touch or take something

****伸手可及的範圍；手臂可及的距離****

Examples

1. Keep the medicine out of children's ****reach****.

請把藥物放在兒童****拿不到的地方****。

2. The keys were just beyond my ****reach****.

鑰匙就在我****搆不到的地方****。

Important phrases:

* ****within reach**** 伸手可及 / 可達成

* ****out of reach**** 搆不到 / 無法實現

* ****beyond reach**** 超出可及範圍

15. within reach / out of reach — figurative possibility

= attainable or unattainable

****可以實現 / 難以實現；觸手可及 / 遙不可及****

This is the exact conceptual extension used in the passage.

Examples

1. Financial independence finally seemed ****within reach****.

經濟獨立終於似乎變得****有望實現****。

2. For many families, buying a home is increasingly ****out of reach****.

對許多家庭而言，買房正變得愈來愈****遙不可及****。

Semantic link

physical closeness

→ easy to touch

→ possible to obtain

→ possible to achieve

16. reach — range or extent of influence, power, communication, or activity

= how far someone or something can influence, operate, communicate, or be effective

****影響範圍；勢力範圍；觸及範圍****

Examples

1. The internet has greatly expanded the ****reach**** of the organization.

網際網路大幅擴大了該組織的****影響範圍****。

2. The charity hopes to extend its ****reach**** into smaller communities.

這家慈善機構希望把其服務****擴展到更多小型社區****。

Common contexts:

* global reach 全球觸及範圍

* media reach 媒體觸及率 / 觸及範圍

* market reach 市場覆蓋範圍

* political reach 政治影響範圍

* organizational reach 組織影響範圍

17. reach — ability to contact or access people

= the number or range of people that a person, organization, medium, or message can contact

****可接觸的人群；觸及能力****

Examples

1. The platform gives artists a much wider ****reach****.

這個平台讓藝術家能****接觸更廣泛的受眾****。

2. Television still has enormous ****reach**** in some markets.

在某些市場，電視仍具有極大的****受眾觸及能力****。

This overlaps with Sense 16 but is especially common in media and marketing.

18. reach — maximum effective distance

= the maximum distance over which something can extend, operate, strike, or function

****有效距離；可及範圍；射程****

Examples

1. The crane has a ****reach**** of nearly fifty metres.
這台起重機的****作業伸展距離****接近五十公尺。
2. The tool gives you extra ****reach**** when working overhead.
這件工具讓你在頭頂作業時有更大的****可及範圍****。

Depending on context, Chinese may be:

- * 伸展範圍
- * 作業範圍
- * 有效距離
- * 射程

19. reach — a continuous stretch or section of a river

= a particular stretch of a river, especially between two points
****河段****

This is an established geographical meaning.

Examples

1. The lower ****reaches**** of the river are heavily populated.
這條河的****下游河段****人口稠密。
2. Flooding affected several ****reaches**** of the river.
洪水影響了這條河的數個****河段****。

Very common fixed forms:

- * ****upper reaches**** 上游
- * ****lower reaches**** 下游
- * ****middle reaches**** 中游

20. the reaches of something

= distant, outer, or extreme parts of an area
****邊遠地區；最外圍部分****

Usually plural and often literary/formal.

Examples

1. Researchers travelled to the northern ****reaches**** of the region.
研究人員前往該地區北部的****偏遠地帶****。
2. The signal can be received in the farthest ****reaches**** of the country.
即使在這個國家最****偏遠的地區****也能收到訊號。

Common:

- * the far reaches of space 太空深處
- * the outer reaches of the empire 帝國邊陲

High-value constructions and expressions

21. out of reach

Physical

****構不到；拿不到****

The shelf was ****out of reach****.
架子高得****構不到****。

Figurative

****無法達成；負擔不起；遙不可及****

A house in the city is ****out of reach**** for many young people.
對許多年輕人而言，在市區買房已****負擔不起****。

22. within easy reach

= close enough to access conveniently
****很容易到達；近在咫尺****

Examples

1. The hotel is ****within easy reach of the airport****.

這家飯店距離機場很近，**交通方便**。

2. Keep important documents **within easy reach**.

把重要文件放在**隨手可拿的位置**。

23. beyond someone's reach

Physical

= too far away to touch

超出某人構得到的範圍

Figurative

= impossible or currently unattainable

超出能力範圍；遙不可及

Examples

1. The branch was just **beyond my reach**.

那根樹枝剛好在我**構不到的位置**。

2. University once seemed **beyond his reach**.

上大學曾經對他來說似乎**遙不可及**。

24. reach for the stars

= aim for something highly ambitious

胸懷大志；追求遠大目標

Examples

1. Her parents always encouraged her to **reach for the stars**.

她的父母總是鼓勵她**追求遠大的目標**。

2. There is nothing wrong with **reaching for the stars** if you remain realistic.

只要保持務實，**追求遠大理想**並沒有問題。

Figurative and idiomatic.

Family and related forms

25. reachable — able to be reached

A. physically accessible

****可到達的****

The village is only ****reachable**** by boat.
那個村莊只能乘船****抵達****。

B. contactable

****可以聯絡到的****

I'll be ****reachable**** by phone all afternoon.
我整個下午都****可以用電話聯絡到****。

26. unreachable

A. impossible to get to

****無法到達的****

Several villages became ****unreachable**** after the storm.
暴風雨後，有幾個村莊變得****無法到達****。

B. impossible to contact

****聯絡不到的****

He was ****unreachable**** for several hours.
有幾個小時完全****聯絡不上他****。

C. impossible to attain

****無法達成的；遙不可及的****

The target is ambitious, but not ****unreachable****.
這個目標很有野心，但並非****無法達成****。

27. far-reaching

= having important effects that extend over a wide area, group, or period

****影響深遠的；範圍廣泛的****

Examples

1. The invention had ****far-reaching consequences****.

這項發明造成了****深遠的影響****。

2. The reforms could have ****far-reaching effects**** on education.

這些改革可能對教育產生****廣泛而深遠的影響****。

This is highly useful and not simply “far + reaching” in ordinary interpretation.

28. outreach

= organized effort to provide information, help, services, or contact to people who might not otherwise receive them

****外展服務；推廣活動；主動接觸社群的工作****

Examples

1. The hospital runs a community ****outreach programme****.

這家醫院設有社區****外展計畫****。

2. The university wants to improve its ****outreach**** to disadvantaged students.

該大學希望加強對弱勢學生的****外展與接觸工作****。

This is a lexicalized family member rather than simply a normal use of the verb ****reach****.

Meaning map

The major semantic development of ****reach**** is very coherent:

****stretch the body toward something****

→ ****be able to touch it****

→ ****arrive at a physical destination****

→ ****arrive at a level or stage****

→ ****attain a goal or result****

→ ****make contact with a person****

→ ****extend influence to people or places****

→ ****range / extent / accessibility****

This explains why apparently different uses such as:

- * reach the shelf
- * reach London
- * reach 30°C
- * reach an agreement
- * reach a customer
- * within reach

all retain the core idea of **extending or progressing until a particular point is attained**.

Essential contrasts

reach vs arrive

reach + object

- * reach the station

arrive + preposition

- * arrive at the station
- * arrive in London

reach vs achieve

reach often conceptualizes a target as a point or destination.

- * reach a goal
- * reach a target
- * reach a level

achieve emphasizes successful accomplishment.

- * achieve success
- * achieve independence
- * achieve an objective

There is substantial overlap with **goal / target / objective**.

reach vs contact

* I couldn't **reach** him.

= I tried but could not successfully get through to him.

* I **contacted** him.

= I communicated with him.

reach more readily emphasizes successful accessibility.

reach vs get to

For physical destinations:

* We **reached the station**.

* We **got to the station**.

Both are natural, but **get to** is more conversational.

Passage recap

> "...made you feel that improvement was **within reach**."

Here:

reach = the range within which something can be obtained

→ figuratively, **a goal close enough to be realistically achievable**

Best Traditional Chinese equivalents:

* **進步是可以做到的**

* **進步是有望達成的**

* **進步並非遙不可及**

* **進步是觸手可及的**

For natural Chinese in this particular passage, **「讓你覺得進步是可以做到的」** is probably the cleanest contextual rendering.

MCQ-ready distinction

If **within reach** appears in a question, the best meaning here is:

****possible to achieve / attainable****

= ****可以達成的；有望實現的****

—not merely “close enough to touch physically.”